D 139 | Separate frame, price and contribution

PRIVATE FICTIONAL adult beverage concept. No brand verdict, pricing change, actual experiment, outreach, customer data, consent or spend.

Original comparison	Original A: 100 qualified offers, 20 buyers, price 80, variable cost 50, marketing 200. Conversion 20%, revenue 1600, gross contribution 600, after marketing 400. Original B: 100/15/100/50/200=>15%, revenue 1500, gross 750, net 550. Conversion falls 5 percentage points (25% relative); net rises 150. Price AND frame changed; frame effect not isolated.
New synthetic cells	Four illustrative cells, not observations: frame A/price 80 buyers 20; A/100 buyers 16; B/80 buyers 24; B/100 buyers 15. Each has 100 offers, cost 50, marketing 200. Comparisons require equal price within frame contrast. Hypothetical extra cells do not repair missing actual assignment or establish real causality.
Interaction matters	Conversion frame contrast B-A: 4 percentage points at 80, -1 at 100; difference-in-differences -5 percentage points. Equal-weight average 1.5 points can hide reversal. Net per offer contrasts 1.2 and-0.5; interaction-1.7, average 0.35. These are descriptive arithmetic contrasts, not significance tests, forecasts or automatically the best price.
Five linked choices	Competitive alternatives include status quo; then differentiated capabilities, buyer-valued outcome, best-fit customer and useful category context. A tagline or fill-in statement summarizes choices; it does not establish them. Common features can be valuable without being differentiation.
Value is a hypothesis	Bain consumer framework has 30 elements/four categories. Use as hypotheses, not a universal premium ladder or proof of an uncopyable moat. B 2 B-focused positioning needs consumer-context testing. Prior brand examples and survey associations are not current Indian brand prices or causal evidence.
Plan only	Blank positioning cards and falsification protocol. If later authorized: comparable randomized 2 x 2 cells, stable offer/channel/exposure rules, predeclared outcome/window, returns/repeat/full costs, uncertainty and stop rule. Randomization is not a guarantee of power or representativeness; no actual experiment authorized.

Inputs | Four fictional frame-price cells

All controls fictional. Counts whole/nonnegative, buyers<=offers; monetary values nonnegative. Changing price/cost alters arithmetic, not a demand curve. Initial common prices 80/100, not enforced as immutable.

A low qualified offers	100.00
A low buyers	20.00
A low price	80.00
A low variable cost	50.00
A low attributable marketing	200.00

A high qualified offers	100.00
A high buyers	16.00
A high price	100.00
A high variable cost	50.00
A high attributable marketing	200.00

Inputs | Four fictional frame-price cells

All controls fictional. Counts whole/nonnegative, buyers<=offers; monetary values nonnegative. Changing price/cost alters arithmetic, not a demand curve. Initial common prices 80/100, not enforced as immutable.

B low qualified offers	100.00
B low buyers	24.00
B low price	80.00
B low variable cost	50.00
B low attributable marketing	200.00

B high qualified offers	100.00
B high buyers	15.00
B high price	100.00
B high variable cost	50.00
B high attributable marketing	200.00

A low numeric controls valid?	1.000000
A high numeric controls valid?	1.000000
B low numeric controls valid?	1.000000
B high numeric controls valid?	1.000000

A valid numeric cell is not a valid causal experiment. If prices differ across the nominal same-price cells, frame contrasts are no longer price-controlled. Comparability and assignment must be checked separately. Zero counts allowed; undefined ratios remain #N/A. No automatic clipping of negative contribution.

A low | Fictional cell economics

One purchase per buyer in this toy; currency units. Net contribution after marketing is not accounting profit, full CAC or LTV.

Conversion fraction	0.200000
Unit contribution	30.000000
Revenue	1600.000000
Contribution before marketing	600.000000
Contribution after marketing	400.000000
Net contribution per qualified offer	4.000000
Marketing per buyer	10.000000

No fixed costs, capacity, refunds, repeat demand or delivery differences supplied. Negative unit contribution retained when variable cost exceeds price. Zero buyers leaves marketing per buyer undefined; zero offers leaves conversion/net per offer undefined. No causal or optimal-price claim.

A high | Fictional cell economics

One purchase per buyer in this toy; currency units. Net contribution after marketing is not accounting profit, full CAC or LTV.

Conversion fraction	0.160000
Unit contribution	50.000000
Revenue	1600.000000
Contribution before marketing	800.000000
Contribution after marketing	600.000000
Net contribution per qualified offer	6.000000
Marketing per buyer	12.500000

No fixed costs, capacity, refunds, repeat demand or delivery differences supplied. Negative unit contribution retained when variable cost exceeds price. Zero buyers leaves marketing per buyer undefined; zero offers leaves conversion/net per offer undefined. No causal or optimal-price claim.

B low | Fictional cell economics

One purchase per buyer in this toy; currency units. Net contribution after marketing is not accounting profit, full CAC or LTV.

Conversion fraction	0.240000
Unit contribution	30.000000
Revenue	1920.000000
Contribution before marketing	720.000000
Contribution after marketing	520.000000
Net contribution per qualified offer	5.200000
Marketing per buyer	8.333333

No fixed costs, capacity, refunds, repeat demand or delivery differences supplied. Negative unit contribution retained when variable cost exceeds price. Zero buyers leaves marketing per buyer undefined; zero offers leaves conversion/net per offer undefined. No causal or optimal-price claim.

B high | Fictional cell economics

One purchase per buyer in this toy; currency units. Net contribution after marketing is not accounting profit, full CAC or LTV.

Conversion fraction	0.150000
Unit contribution	50.000000
Revenue	1500.000000
Contribution before marketing	750.000000
Contribution after marketing	550.000000
Net contribution per qualified offer	5.500000
Marketing per buyer	13.333333

No fixed costs, capacity, refunds, repeat demand or delivery differences supplied. Negative unit contribution retained when variable cost exceeds price. Zero buyers leaves marketing per buyer undefined; zero offers leaves conversion/net per offer undefined. No causal or optimal-price claim.

Contrasts | Averages can hide a reversal

Fractions except explicitly labeled percentage points. Descriptive toy arithmetic only, not uncertainty estimates or significance. Unequal same-price inputs yield #N/A in frame contrasts; still no actual assignment verified.

Frame conversion contrast at low price	0.040000
Frame conversion contrast at high price	-0.010000
Conversion interaction:high minus low	-0.050000
Equal-weight average frame conversion contrast	0.015000
Frame net/offer contrast at low price	1.200000
Frame net/offer contrast at high price	-0.500000
Net/offer interaction:high minus low	-1.700000
Equal-weight average frame net/offer contrast	0.350000
Original B-A conversion:percentage points	-5.000000
Original B-A conversion:relative change	-0.250000
Original B-A net contribution	150.000000
Original B-A net contribution per offer	1.500000

Baseline .04, -.01, -.05, .015, 1.2, -.5, -1.7, .35, -5, -.25, 150, 1.5. Equal-weight average is chosen for this balanced illustrative design, not universal traffic weighting. Reweighting or changed populations changes estimand. Do not infer real premium, moat, causality or optimal price.

Design plan | Falsify a buyer-value link

Unsent planning prompts, not an approved or completed experiment.

Positioning cards	For two frames: name competitive alternatives/status quo; capabilities relative to alternatives; buyer-valued outcomes with evidence gaps; best-fit buyer/occasion; category context. State expected assumptions and delivery costs. No invented real-brand capability or current price.
Value hypotheses	Functional, emotional, life-changing, social-impact are categories, not a guaranteed price hierarchy. Test relevance and tradeoffs rather than assuming nostalgia/identity creates a durable moat. Record switching, replication costs and rival explanations.
Factorial follow-up	Plan comparable 2 x 2 frame and price combinations, random assignment at a justified unit, consistent eligibility/channel/exposure, predeclared outcome/window and treatment implementation checks. Prevent contamination; consider time/channel blocks. Sample size and consent remain unresolved, not assumed sufficient.
Outcomes and uncertainty	Primary net contribution per qualified offer with clearly scoped costs; also conversion, refunds, returns, repeat behavior and implementation/experience costs. Predeclare decision and stopping rules; account for uncertainty and multiple comparisons. No p-values or confidence intervals calculated here.
Survey is not experiment	Bain 2019 reports US survey/growth associations, not randomized price premiums or independent causal proof. Threshold 8+/40% is their operational rule, not universal truth. Historical illustrative brand examples not current verified facts. No figures or AV visually inspected.
Decision boundary	An average can hide an interaction; check simple contrasts and target context. No deployment, price change, ad spend, outreach, persona account, actual participant or experiment. Blank work stays blank. Fullsource/AV, nativecrossviewer, independentlearner/account/field and overall 10 remain open.

Actual work | Blank positioning and falsification cards

No actual customer, consent, quote, experiment, randomized assignment or price change. Complete only as a private hypothetical plan.

Frame	Alternatives	Capabilities	Buyer value	Best-fit buyer	Category	Disconfirmation

Comparable cells / unit / randomization	
Primary outcome / window / costs	
Power / uncertainty / consent gap	
Returns / repeat / delivery costs	
Stop rule / counterevidence / next step	

No simulated customer quote presented as real. Blank consent is not consent. Original exercise/quiz retained; change one family, recompute, explain and restore. Spreadsheet validity does not establish experiment validity.

Evidence | Written design support, not buyer proof

SixURLs/fourorganizations: author explanation, practitioner overview/reported survey, statistical reference and accounting definitions. Not six independent tests.

Dunford 2020	https://www.aprildunford.com/post/an-introduction-to-positioning | Complete returned written article read; five components, context, statement limits. Not full book, images or recording. B 2 B-to-consumer transfer unverified.
Bain 2016	https://www.bain.com/insights/the-elements-of-value-hbr/ | Complete returned written introductory excerpt read, not full HBR article.30 consumer elements/four categories; no universal premium or moat conclusion.
Bain 2019	https://www.bain.com/globalassets/noindex/2019/bain__brief_the_power_of_delivering_elements_of_value_in_consumer_products.pdf | Returned written brief read including survey/method/figure-caption text. US associations, not causal evidence; no underlying data, figure pixels or current brand verification.
NIST factorial	https://itl.nist.gov/div898/handbook/pri/section3/pri3332.htm | Complete returned written three-factor example/tables read; factor combinations, interactions, replication, randomization. Adapted design reasoning, not beverage efficacy; figures not inspected.
NIST random	https://www.itl.nist.gov/div898/handbook/pri/section3/pri331.htm | Complete returned written one-factor reference read. Random assignment and balance; not power calculation or actual assignment. No general guarantee of representative samples.
OpenStax terms	https://openstax.org/books/principles-managerial-accounting/pages/3-key-terms | Complete returned written chapter 3 keyterms read: unit/total contribution, fixed-cost recovery, relevant range. Not wholechapter/book. No AV, crossviewer, independentlearner/account/field or overall 10 claim.

Failure log | Authored checks, not market validation

Changed/invalid controls, broken references and clean restore. No actual experiment or learner transfer verified.

1	PASS: 44 baseline formulas independently recomputed.
2	PASS: 24 changed sets plus clean restore.
3	PASS: 16 invalid controls/704 isolation checks.
4	PASS: 6 broken references/6 explicit error checks.
5	PASS: 4 price mismatches/176 comparability checks.
6	PASS: zero denominators retain undefined ratios.
7	PASS: negative contribution retained,not clipped.
8	PASS: actual positioning cards/protocol blank.